



SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

INTERNAL HACKATHON

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK



Purpose. This Internal Hackathon is the institute-level screening stage for SIH 2026. Teams will select official SIH problem statements, prepare an idea presentation, present before the jury, and compete for selection for the official SIH nomination process.

1. Internal Hackathon Workflow

Stage	Phase	What Happens
01	Rulebook Release	Rules, process and deadlines are published.
02	Team Registration	Students form/register teams through the dedicated registration system.
03	PS Selection & Preparation	Teams choose up to two Problem Statements and prepare their solution/PPT.
04	PPT Upload Deadline	Final Idea Presentation must be uploaded before the announced deadline.
05	Internal Hackathon Day	Teams present their ideas to the jury and are evaluated.
06	Result Announcement	Scores are compiled and selected/waitlisted teams are announced.

2. Eligibility & Team Formation

- Each SIH team must consist of exactly 6 student members, including the Team Leader.
- All team members must belong to the same college; inter-college teams are not permitted.
- At least one female team member is mandatory.
- For the Internal Hackathon, students may form teams across different departments, branches, and academic years, provided the official SIH same-college and team-composition requirements are satisfied.
- Multidisciplinary teams are encouraged, particularly for Hardware problem statements.

3. Registration & Team Leader

- The Team Leader will act as the primary point of contact for the team during the Internal Hackathon.
- The Team Leader is responsible for ensuring that team details, selected Problem Statements and required submissions are accurate and complete.
- Only teams selected through the Internal Hackathon will be eligible for nomination by the College SPOC to SIH 2026.
- Official SIH nomination/submission is handled through the College SPOC; students do not directly register on the official SIH portal.



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4. Problem Statement Selection

- Teams must select official SIH 2026 Problem Statements made available for the Internal Hackathon.
- Each team may select a maximum of 2 Problem Statements.
- Teams may select Problem Statements from Software and/or Hardware categories.
- Teams should study the problem carefully and choose statements that match their skills, resources, and ability to produce a convincing solution.
- Once the Internal Hackathon deadline for Problem Statement locking has passed, changes will require approval from the Overall Coordinator.
- Teams are encouraged to discuss both the problem and proposed solution before finalizing their selected Problem Statements.

5. Idea Presentation / PPT Rules

- The Idea Presentation must follow the prescribed SIH format/requirements applicable to the official submission and must be submitted in PDF format.
- Teams must submit the final Idea Presentation before the announced PPT upload deadline.
- The presentation should clearly explain the problem, proposed solution, innovation, feasibility, impact, implementation approach and relevant technical details.
- One or two team members may present the PPT; presentation by every member is not mandatory.
- All team members must understand the proposed solution because the jury may direct questions to any member during evaluation.
- The submitted presentation must represent the team's own work and must not contain plagiarized or misleading material.

6. Preparation Period

- After team registration, a dedicated preparation period will be provided for Problem Statement selection, solution development and PPT preparation.
- Teams should use this period to understand the selected Problem Statement, validate their idea, divide responsibilities and prepare for jury questions.
- The final internal event is an idea-screening and evaluation stage; teams should focus on a clear, feasible and well-justified solution rather than unnecessary complexity.

7. Internal Hackathon Day

- Teams must report/check in within the time communicated by the organizing committee.
- Each team will receive a fixed presentation and/or Q&A slot.
- The presentation format, duration and room allocation will be communicated before the event.
- The jury will evaluate the team's submitted idea and presentation using the announced evaluation criteria.
- The evaluation process will be conducted uniformly for all teams.
- The organizing committee may make practical operational adjustments on the event day when required.

8. Evaluation Criteria

The internal evaluation will be aligned with the official SIH idea-selection factors. The jury will consider the following aspects:

- Novelty and originality of the idea
- Complexity and depth of the proposed solution
- Clarity and completeness of the presentation



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- Feasibility and practicability
- Sustainability and scope for implementation
- Scale of potential impact
- User experience / usability
- Potential for future development or progression

Practical evaluation. The Jury & Hackathon Management team will design the final marking structure according to the official SIH factors while keeping the process realistic and appropriate for the institute's environment.

9. Originality, Conduct & Disqualification

- The idea/solution submitted by a team must be new and must not have been presented or developed as part of a previous event/program in a way that violates SIH expectations.
- Plagiarism, false information, impersonation, deliberate misrepresentation, misconduct or violation of the stated rules may lead to disqualification.
- Participants must maintain professional and respectful conduct with organizers, jury members, faculty, volunteers and other participants.
- Any attempt to influence jury members, manipulate evaluation, or disrupt the event may result in disqualification.
- The organizing committee may investigate serious violations and take appropriate action.

10. AI & External Tools

- The Internal Hackathon rulebook does not impose a separate AI restriction beyond the requirement of originality and genuine understanding of the team's proposed solution.
- Teams remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, feasibility and understanding of anything included in their presentation.
- If asked by the jury, team members must be able to explain their proposed solution, workflow, technical choices and implementation approach.

11. Selection for Official SIH 2026

- Internal Hackathon participation does not guarantee official SIH selection.
- The highest-performing teams, based on the internal evaluation and available nomination capacity, will be shortlisted for nomination.
- The College SPOC will nominate the selected teams through the official SIH portal.
- Official SIH team details entered by the SPOC are subject to the official portal process and data-verification requirements.
- For the official SIH process, the nominated Team Leader will complete the required idea-submission information, including team verification, selected Problem Statement/category, idea title, idea description and Idea Presentation PDF.

12. Important Official SIH Notes

- The official SIH 2026 guideline states that one team may submit ideas against a maximum of 2 Problem Statements.
- The official SIH 2026 guideline states that the last date for team nomination and idea submission on the SIH portal is 20 September 2026.
- The official guideline states that the Grand Finale is proposed to be conducted offline at nodal centres across India, with the finale proposed for December 2026.
- Detailed official SIH requirements may supersede any internal operational instruction where the two differ.



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13. Final Participant Checklist

- ☐ I am part of a valid 6-member team.
- ☐ All team members belong to the same college.
- ☐ Our team includes at least one female member.
- ☐ Our Team Leader and member details are accurate.
- ☐ We have selected no more than 2 official SIH Problem Statements.
- ☐ We understand the selected Problem Statement(s) and our proposed solution.
- ☐ Our final Idea Presentation is prepared in the required format and PDF form.
- ☐ Our PPT has been uploaded before the deadline.
- ☐ Our presenting member(s) are prepared for the jury presentation and Q&A.
- ☐ All team members can explain the proposed solution if asked.

14. Important Contacts & Official Reference

Official Organizing Committee	PRAGYAN
Overall Coordinator	Aditya Singh
Faculty Coordinator	Dr. Shobhit Srivastava
Official SIH Website	sih.gov.in

This rulebook is prepared for the SIH 2026 Internal Hackathon and is aligned with the official SIH 2026 Guidelines. Where an official SIH requirement differs from an internal instruction, the official SIH requirement will prevail.